

CNuvS Ex. 4 - Jan Lindauer, Paul Feidieker

Task 3

- (a) Routing is the process of determining the route taken by packets from source to destination. Forwarding is the process of moving packets from router's input to appropriate router output. [1, p. 4]
- (b)
1. Distance vector routing has a limited view. The routers only know what direct neighbors tell them. Link state routing has a global view. Each router knows the entire network topology.
 2. Distance vector routing uses the Bellman-Ford algorithm. Link state routing uses Dijkstra's algorithm.
 3. Distance vector routing is slow to adapt to changes. It periodically broadcasts the entire routing table to its neighbors. Link state routing is faster to adapt to changes. It only sends updates when there are changes in the network topology.
- (c) To guarantee that a node has found the shortest path to every other node in the network, we have to guarantee that all paths to all nodes have been propagated. Each node has two neighbors so the first two update rounds are caused by a message from both neighbors propagating the distance to the opposing node from the one we picked. This opposing node also propagates its initial state to the two neighbors that it shares with our node. Since there could potentially be a shorter path to one of our neighbors via the other neighbor and that the opposing node we also have to consider those two update rounds to really guarantee the shortest path to each node. So in total we need 4 update rounds for each node to be sure.
- (d) The "count-to-infinity" problem will occur when a link failure occurs in $\min_w \{D^X(Y, w)\}$

Sources

- [1] Prof. Dr. Marco Zimmerling, "Computer Networks & Distributed Systems Chapter 2: Routing." 2026.